STATE & GOVERNMENT UNDER AKBAR (MANSABDARI, DAHSALA)

STATE CAPACITY AS AN → ADMINISTRATIVE EVOLUTION 1556-1605 → CENTRAL OFFICES AND RULER-CENTRED → PROVINCE TO VILLAGE: HIERARCHY → MANSABDARI: RANK, REMUNERATION AND → ZAT, SAWAR AND JAGIR

Read the thick spine left from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVISE

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artifacts unchanged • exact same master dividers poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

STATE CAPACITY AS AN INTEGRATED ARCHITECTURE

STATE CAPACITY AS AN INTEGRATED ARCHITECTURE · RULER-CENTRED AUTHORITY · APPOINTMENT, TRANSFER, PROMOTION AND JUDGEMENT · DIFFERENTIATED FINANCE, MILITARY, HOUSEHOLD AND GRANT FUNCTIONS · RANKS ELITE STATUS, REMUNERATION AND SERVICE OBLIGATION · MEASUREMENT, AVERAGES, RECORDS AND LOCAL MEDIATION FUND THE STATE · DAGH, CHEHRA, ACCOUNTS AND NEWS TEST PAPER CLAIMS · SUBSTANTIAL CAPACITY REMAINED PERSONAL, HIERARCHICAL AND UNEVEN.

RULER-CENTRED AUTHORITY → appointment, transfer, promotion and judgement

OFFICES → differentiated finance, military, household and grant functions → MANSABDARI → ranks elite status, remuneration and service obligation → REVENUE → measurement, averages, records and local mediation fund the state

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RULER-CENTRED AUTHORITY → appointment, transfer, promotion and judgement
- OFFICES → differentiated finance, military, household and grant functions
- MANSABDARI → ranks elite status, remuneration and service obligation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- REVENUE → measurement, averages, records and local mediation fund the state
- VERIFICATION → dagh, chehra, accounts and news test paper claims
- VERDICT: substantial capacity remained personal, hierarchical and uneven.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MUST REMEMBER: Mansab ranked service through zat and sawar; jagir assigned revenue and did not confer private ownership of land.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → VERDICT: substantial capacity remained personal, hierarchical and uneven.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Mansab ranked service through zat and sawar; jagir assigned revenue and did not confer private ownership of land.

01

STAGE 01

ADMINISTRATIVE EVOLUTION 1556-1605

ADMINISTRATIVE EVOLUTION 1556-1605 · BAIRAM KHAN AS POWERFUL WAKIL DURING MINORITY · MUZAFFAR KHAN TURBATI STRENGTHENS THE DIWAN'S FISCAL ROLE · NUMERICAL MANSAB HIERARCHY ASSOCIATED WITH THE 11TH REGNAL YEAR · DAGH INTRODUCED · TODAR MAL AS MUSHRIF-I-DIWAN · DAHSALA AND TWELVE SUBAS · ZAT-SAWAR DISTINCTION IN THE 40TH REGNAL YEAR.

1556 → Bairam Khan as powerful wakil during minority → 1565 → Muzaffar Khan Turbati strengthens the diwan's fiscal role → 1567 → numerical mansab hierarchy associated with the 11th regnal year → 1573-74 → dagh introduced → 1575 → Todar Mal as mushrif-i-diwan

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1556 → Bairam Khan as powerful wakil during minority
- 1565 → Muzaffar Khan Turbati strengthens the diwan's fiscal role
- 1567 → numerical mansab hierarchy associated with the 11th regnal year

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1573-74 → dagh introduced
- 1575 → Todar Mal as mushrif-i-diwan
- 1580 → dahsala and twelve subas

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1595-96 → zat-sawar distinction in the 40th regnal year.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1595-96 → zat-sawar distinction in the 40th regnal year.

02

STAGE 02

CENTRAL OFFICES AND RULER-CENTRED CHECKS

CENTRAL OFFICES AND RULER-CENTRED CHECKS · APPOINTMENTS + TRANSFERS + JUSTICE + COURT ACCESS · REGENCY CONCENTRATION REDUCED AFTER BAIRAM · MIR BAKHSHI · MANSAB PRESENTATION + MUSTER + PAY + INTELLIGENCE · GRANTS AND JUDICIAL-RELIGIOUS FUNCTIONS; POWERS CHANGE · MIR SAMAN · HOUSEHOLD, KARKHANAS, STORES AND ACCOUNTS

PADSHAH → appointments + transfers + justice + court access

WAKIL → regency concentration reduced after Bairam → DIWAN → revenue/accounts/khalisa/jagir/expenditure → MIR BAKHSHI → mansab presentation + muster + pay + intelligence

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PADSHAH → appointments + transfers + justice + court access
- WAKIL → regency concentration reduced after Bairam
- DIWAN → revenue/accounts/khalisa/jagir/expenditure

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- MIR BAKHSHI → mansab presentation + muster + pay + intelligence
- SADR / QAZI → grants and judicial-religious functions; powers change
- MIR SAMAN / BUYUTAT → household, karkhanas, stores and accounts

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULE: overlapping reports checked officers but centred the emperor.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → RULE: overlapping reports checked officers but centred the emperor.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: overlapping reports checked officers but centred the emperor.

03

STAGE 03

PROVINCE TO VILLAGE: HIERARCHY AND COUNTERWEIGHTS

PROVINCE TO VILLAGE · HIERARCHY AND COUNTERWEIGHTS · SUBADAR + PROVINCIAL DIWAN + BAKHSHI + SADR/QAZI + · FAUJDAR + AMALGUZAR/AMIL; JURISDICTIONS MAY OVERLAP · SHIQDAR + AMIN/MUNSIF + QANUNGO + CHAUDHURI + FOTEDAR/KARKUN · MUQADDAM/HEADMAN + PATWARI + PANCHAYAT + CULTIVATOR · LOCAL POWER · ZAMINDAR/CHIEF RIGHTS, FORTS, ARMED FOLLOWING AND CUSTOM

SUBA → subadar + provincial diwan + bakhshi + sadr/qazi + news writer

SARKAR → faujdar + amalguzar/amil; jurisdictions may overlap → PARGANA → shiqdar + amin/munsif + qanungo + chaudhuri + fotedar/karkun → VILLAGE → muqaddam/headman + patwari + panchayat + cultivator

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SUBA → subadar + provincial diwan + bakhshi + sadr/qazi + news writer
- SARKAR → faujdar + amalguzar/amil; jurisdictions may overlap
- PARGANA → shiqdar + amin/munsif + qanungo + chaudhuri + fotedar/karkun

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VILLAGE → muqaddam/headman + patwari + panchayat + cultivator
- LOCAL POWER → zamindar/chief rights, forts, armed following and custom
- 1580 → twelve subas; later conquest changes count, often fifteen by reign-end

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAUTION: formal ladder did not erase negotiated/regional practice.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: formal ladder did not erase negotiated/regional practice.

04

STAGE 04

MANSABDARI: RANK, REMUNERATION AND OBLIGATION

RANK, REMUNERATION AND OBLIGATION · NUMERICAL STATUS + REMUNERATION + SERVICE RELATION · TURANI + IRANI + AFGHAN + INDIAN MUSLIM + · RULER-CENTRED INTEGRATION AND DISCIPLINE · MILITARY + PROVINCIAL + COURT + ADMINISTRATIVE ROLES · CASH OR JAGIR REALIZATION; RANK IS NOT LAND OWNERSHIP · ARMY WAS NOT MANSAB CAVALRY ALONE · NOT A MODERN MERIT CIVIL SERVICE OR ONE STATIC

MANSAB → numerical status + remuneration + service relation

RECRUIT → Turani + Irani + Afghan + Indian Muslim + Rajput + others → APPOINT/PROMOTE/TRANSFER → ruler-centred integration and discipline → SERVICE → military + provincial + court + administrative roles

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- MANSAB → numerical status + remuneration + service relation
- RECRUIT → Turani + Irani + Afghan + Indian Muslim + Rajput + others
- APPOINT/PROMOTE/TRANSFER → ruler-centred integration and discipline

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SERVICE → military + provincial + court + administrative roles
- PAY → cash or jagir realization; rank is not land ownership
- AHADIS/ARTILLERY/INFANTRY → army was not mansab cavalry alone

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAUTION: not a modern merit civil service or one static table.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: not a modern merit civil service or one static table.

05

STAGE 05

ZAT, SAWAR AND JAGIR LOGIC

ZAT, SAWAR AND JAGIR LOGIC · LATE AKBAR · ZAT BROADLY PERSONAL RANK/PAY · SAWAR CAVALRY OBLIGATION · CHANGED; EARLIER RANKS CANNOT BE READ THROUGH FINAL FORMULA · TANKHWAH JAGIR · REVENUE ASSIGNMENT IN LIEU OF SALARY · REVENUE RESERVED FOR CENTRAL EXPENDITURE

LATE AKBAR → ZAT broadly personal rank/pay · SAWAR cavalry obligation

JAMA → assessed paper demand · HASIL → amount realized

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LATE AKBAR → ZAT broadly personal rank/pay
- SAWAR cavalry obligation
- RATIOS/CATEGORIES → changed; earlier ranks cannot be read through final formula

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- TANKHWAH JAGIR → revenue assignment in lieu of salary
- KHALISA → revenue reserved for central expenditure
- JAMA → assessed paper demand

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HASIL → amount realized
- MASHRUT/DU-ASPA SIH-ASPA → later Mughal refinements, not normal Akbar
- DEPENDENCE → salary, status and assignment tied elite to emperor.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DEPENDENCE → salary, status and assignment tied elite to emperor.

06

STAGE 06

DAGH, CHEHRA AND THE VERIFICATION PROBLEM

DAGH, CHEHRA AND THE VERIFICATION PROBLEM · PAPER RANK · CLAIMED CAVALRY OBLIGATION · DESCRIPTIVE ROLL OF TROOPER/PERSONNEL · BRANDED HORSE IDENTIFICATION AND INSPECTION · AKBAR-PERIOD STRENGTHENING WITH SULTANATE/SUR PRECEDENTS · MIR BAKHSHI RECORDS, DEDUCTIONS, CATEGORIES AND RESISTANCE · SUBSTITUTION/CORRUPTION/HARASSMENT CAN SURVIVE DOCUMENTATION

PAPER RANK → claimed cavalry obligation · CHEHRA → descriptive roll of trooper/personnel → DAGH → branded horse identification and inspection → 1573-74 → Akbar-period strengthening with Sultanate/Sur precedents → MUSTER → mir bakhshi records, deductions, categories and resistance

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PAYER RANK → claimed cavalry obligation
- CHEHRA → descriptive roll of trooper/personnel
- DAGH → branded horse identification and inspection

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 1573-74 → Akbar-period strengthening with Sultanate/Sur precedents
- MUSTER → mir bakhshi records, deductions, categories and resistance
- GAP → substitution/corruption/harassment can survive documentation

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULE: verification reduces but never eliminates paper-versus-field divergence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE: verification reduces but never eliminates paper-versus-field divergence.

07

STAGE 07

REVENUE REFORM AS EXPERIMENT

REVENUE REFORM AS EXPERIMENT · RESTORED SYSTEMS + CENTRAL PRICE PROBLEMS + PROVINCIAL VARIATION · KAROR/MEASUREMENT AND RECORD EXPERIMENTS · MUZAFFAR KHAN + TODAR MAL + SHAH MANSUR + · ILAHI GAZ/BIGHA + IRON-RING BAMBOO JARIB · POLAJ + PARAUTI + CHACHAR + BANJAR · CROP/PRICE DATA ORGANIZED INTO REGIONAL DASTUR CIRCLES · REFORM EVOLVED THROUGH TRIAL, OFFICIALS AND LOCAL INFORMATION.

EARLY → restored systems + central price problems + provincial variation · 1570s → karori/measurement and record experiments → TEAM → Muzaffar Khan + Todar Mal + Shah Mansur + local qanungos → MEASURE → ilahi gaz/bigha + iron-ring bamboo jarib → CLASSIFY → polaj + parauti + chachar + banjar

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- EARLY → restored systems + central price problems + provincial variation
- 1570s → karori/measurement and record experiments
- TEAM → Muzaffar Khan + Todar Mal + Shah Mansur + local qanungos

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- MEASURE → Ilahi gaz/bigha + iron-ring bamboo jarib
- CLASSIFY → polaj + parauti + chachar + banjar
- RATE → crop/price data organized into regional dastur circles

IMPACT / LIMIT

- RULE: reform evolved through trial, officials and local information.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → RULE: reform evolved through trial, officials and local information.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: reform evolved through trial, officials and local information.

08

STAGE 08

ZABT-DAHSALA CALCULATION CHAIN

ZABT-DAHSALA CALCULATION CHAIN · MEASURE AREA AND IDENTIFY CROP/LAND CATEGORY · TEN-YEAR PRODUCE AND PRICE INFORMATION · AVERAGES SUPPORT ANNUAL CASH-RATE SCHEDULE · REGIONAL CROP-PRICE/RATE CIRCLE, NOT EMPIRE-WIDE PRICE · QUALIFIED ONE-THIRD NORM + CESSES/COLLECTION REALITIES · CASH RISK TO CULTIVATOR · NOT TEN-YEAR TAX, PERMANENT SETTLEMENT OR UNIFORM COVERAGE.

ZABT → measure area and identify crop/land category → DATA → ten-year produce and price information → DAHSALA → averages support annual cash-rate schedule → DASTUR → regional crop-price/rate circle, not empire-wide price → DEMAND → qualified one-third norm + cesses/collection realities

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ZABT → measure area and identify crop/land category
- DATA → ten-year produce and price information
- DAHSALA → averages support annual cash-rate schedule

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- DASTUR → regional crop-price/rate circle, not empire-wide price
- DEMAND → qualified one-third norm + cesses/collection realities
- JAMA → assessment

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HASIL → realization
- cash risk to cultivator
- CAUTION: not ten-year tax, permanent settlement or uniform coverage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: not ten-year tax, permanent settlement or uniform coverage.

09

STAGE 09

METHODS, GEOGRAPHY AND MEDIATION

METHODS, GEOGRAPHY AND MEDIATION · MEASURED CASH SCHEDULE IN SETTLED/RECORDED/MONETIZED ZONES · CROP SHARING AFTER HARVEST; VARIANTS DIFFER · MEASURE PLUS STANDING-CROP APPRAISAL · ESTIMATE FROM PRIOR/LOCAL DEMAND WITHOUT FULL FRESH SURVEY · BENGAL/DELTA + HILLS/FOREST/FRONTIER + UNCERTAIN CROPS LIMIT ZABT · ZAMINDAR + CHAUDHURI + QANUNGO + MUQADDAM + PATWARI · METHOD FOLLOWED ECOLOGY, RECORDS, CROP AND BARGAINING.

ZABT → measured cash schedule in settled/recorded/monetized zones · BATAI → crop sharing after harvest; variants differ · KANKUT → measure plus standing-crop appraisal · NASAQ → estimate from prior/local demand without full fresh survey · REGION → Bengal/delta + hills/forest/frontier + uncertain crops limit zabt · MEDIATION → zamindar + chaudhuri + qanungo + muqaddam + patwari

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ZABT → measured cash schedule in settled/recorded/monetized zones
- BATAI → crop sharing after harvest; variants differ
- KANKUT → measure plus standing-crop appraisal

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- NASAQ → estimate from prior/local demand without full fresh survey
- REGION → Bengal/delta + hills/forest/frontier + uncertain crops limit zabt
- MEDIATION → zamindar + chaudhuri + qanungo + muqaddam + patwari

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULE: method followed ecology, records, crop and bargaining.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Zabt and dahsala depended on measurement, prices and assessment but were not uniformly applicable everywhere.

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: high state capacity through negotiated, uneven implementation.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Imperial regulations must be distinguished from local practice, crop variation and later administrative adjustment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → RULE: method followed ecology, records, crop and bargaining.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Zabt and dahsala depended on measurement, prices and assessment but were not uniformly applicable everywhere.

10

STAGE 10

CONTINUITY, EVIDENCE AND STRUCTURAL LIMITS

CONTINUITY, EVIDENCE AND STRUCTURAL LIMITS · AIN IDEAL/ENUMERATION VERSUS FARMAN/RECORD/COIN/REGIONAL OUTCOME · ASSIGNMENT + MEASURE + DAGH/CHEHRA + LOCAL OFFICES · SUBA CHECKS + MANSAB-JAGIR + EVOLVING ZABT/DAHSALA METHODS · JAMA-HASIL + JAGIR PRESSURE + PAPER TROOPS + CORRUPTION · STRONG BUT PERSONAL, DEPENDENT ON APPOINTMENTS/REPORTS · JAHANGIR/SHAH JAHAN CHANGES; NO CRISIS PROJECTED FULLY BACKWARD · HIGH STATE CAPACITY THROUGH NEGOTIATED, UNEVEN IMPLEMENTATION.

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- SOURCE → Ain ideal/enumeration versus farman/record/coin/regional outcome
- SULTANATE/SUR → assignment + measure + dagh/chehra + local offices
- AKBAR → suba checks + mansab-jagir + evolving zabt/dahsala methods

METHOD / DEBATE

- TENSIONS → jama-hasil + jagir pressure + paper troops + corruption + cash risk
- CENTRE → strong but personal, dependent on appointments/reports
- LATER → Jahangir/Shah Jahan changes; no crisis projected fully backward

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: high state capacity through negotiated, uneven implementation.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Imperial regulations must be distinguished from local practice, crop variation and later administrative adjustment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → VERDICT: high state capacity through negotiated, uneven implementation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Imperial regulations must be distinguished from local practice, crop variation and later administrative adjustment.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 16 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 16 ANSWER SPINE · AIN NORM + DOCUMENT/REGION + ASSESSMENT/REALIZATION DISTINCTION · RULER-CENTRED CENTRAL/PROVINCIAL CHECKS · MANSAB + ZAT/SAWAR + JAGIR + MUSTER/TRANSFER · MEASURE + CATEGORIES + DASTUR + DAHSALA + ALTERNATIVE · ZAMINDAR/CHAUDHURI/QANUNGO/MUQADDAM/PATWARI + DIFFERENTIATED PEASANTS · ECOLOGY + CASH + CORRUPTION + JAMA-HASIL + PERSONAL · MAJOR TEAM-BUILT SYSTEM, NEITHER SOLE INVENTION NOR IMPERSONAL UNIFORM

SOURCE → Ain norm + document/region + assessment/realization distinction → OFFICES → ruler-centred central/provincial checks → ELITE → mansab + zat/sawar + jagir + muster/transfer → FISCAL → measure + categories + dastur + dahsala + alternative methods → LOCAL → zamindar/chaudhuri/qanungo/muqaddam/patwari + differentiated peasants

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SOURCE → Ain norm + document/region + assessment/realization distinction
- OFFICES → ruler-centred central/provincial checks
- ELITE → mansab + zat/sawar + jagir + muster/transfer

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- FISCAL → measure + categories + dastur + dahsala + alternative methods
- LOCAL → zamindar/chaudhuri/qanungo/muqaddam/patwari + differentiated peasants
- LIMIT → ecology + cash + corruption + jama-hasil + personal centre

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT → major team- built system, neither sole invention nor impersonal uniform state.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → major team- built system, neither sole invention nor impersonal uniform state.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · STATE & GOVERNMENT UNDER AKBAR (MANSABDARI, DAHSALA) — ADVANCED · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · 5. UPSC TRAPS · 6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- State & Government under Akbar (Mansabdari, Dahsala) — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- • Concept note (PYQ gap)
- • Part II argues that Akbar inherited Sultanate structures but reorganised departments so their
- • functions did not encroach on each other and yet balanced one another.

OPTIONAL STATUS → This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels